

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q T

♦ J T 9 5 2

♣ K 6 5

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 9 6

♦ 8 3

♣ A J T 7 3



♠ J T 9 8 5

♥ K J 8 7 4

♦ -

♣ Q 9 8

♠ 6 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A K Q 7 6 4

♣ 4 2

With 11 points and a beautiful 6-card suit this is the perfect hand for a Weak-2 opener. So you open 2♦. Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. You are expected to rebid your suit if you have a minimum (6-8 point) hand. Otherwise you are to bid an outside suit in which you hold a high card - this is called "showing a feature". And the final possibility is this one, where you have a solid suit, either A K Q x x x or A K J 10 x x. In this case you bid 3NT.

|              |       |      |       |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| West         | North | East | South |
|              |       |      | 2♦    |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |

South would play 3NT.

Click

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠J. West plays ♠K.

**North plays 3NT. East leads ♠J. West plays ♠K.**

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 7

The ♠ lead assures you of two tricks in the suit. So you only need to create two more. If the ♦s split 3-2 (likely) you could get 3 extra tricks there. But there's a danger - if they split 4-1 you wouldn't have an entry to them. Well, you wouldn't have an entry unless you **DUCKED** the first ♦. Then a 4-1 split wouldn't prevent you from making 5 ♦ winners.

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

**East shows out.**

Make **PLAN B**, then

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

**East shows out.**

That's tough. No matter how you play them you can only get 3 ♦ winners. So you must turn elsewhere - elsewhere being the ♣ suit.

Win the ♦Q but don't play another ♦ yet, you need an entry back to dummy later. Instead, lead the ♣2 and finesse your ♣T. East will win with one of the high ♣s and probably return a ♠. You may as well take the ♠Q now. Play your ♦8 to dummy's ♦K, cash the ♦A, then play the ♣4, finessing your ♣J. Fortunately this wins and when you cash your ♣A both defenders follow. The rest of your clubs are good and you make an overtrick.

Sometimes you have to change your plan.

When the ♦s turned out to be 5-0 you had to get lucky. Your back-up Plan wasn't likely to work - it required the missing ♣ honors to be split, but also required a 3-3 ♣ split, not a likely outcome.

But there was no other choice so you have to try it.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 5  
♥ K 9  
♦ 8 7 6 4 2  
♣ A 8 5 3

♠ 9 4

♥ Q 5 2

♦ Q T 9

♣ Q J 9 6 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A J T 8 7 4

♦ K 5

♣ 4

♠ Q J T 8 3

♥ 6 3

♦ A J 3

♣ K T 7

|      |       |      |       |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|

|  |  |    |    |
|--|--|----|----|
|  |  | 1♥ | 1♠ |
|--|--|----|----|

|      |      |    |      |
|------|------|----|------|
| Pass | Pass | 3♥ | Pass |
|------|------|----|------|

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

to your hand and ruff the ♠7 with dummy's ♥9. North may over-ruff this, but only with a trump trick he was going to win anyway.

You will lose two ♦s and the ♥Q but no more.

It is tempting to ruff the first ♠ with dummy's ♥9, hoping to sneak that through then ruff the second one with ♥K.

The problem is that North would have over-ruffed the ♥9 and then played another ♥ and you would not have gotten to ruff either ♠,

You open 1♥, South overcalls 1♠ and partner passes.

You shouldn't let South steal from you so you will bid your ♥s again. You must decide between 2♥ and 3♥. Given that partner might have had a pretty decent hand yet still have to pass, you decide to go with 3♥. Partner bids 4♥.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠Q.

**East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠Q.**

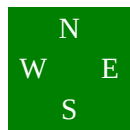
Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 5

Win the ♠K, then enter dummy with the ♣A and play another ♠ toward your ♠A. You do this to prevent North ruffing your high ♠. Next you lead the ♠2 and ruff with dummy's ♥K. Ruff a ♣ to get back

**Board 3**  
 South Deals  
 None Vul

♠ Q 3 2  
 ♥ 9 5  
 ♦ Q 8 7 2  
 ♣ K Q T 9

♠ J 9 8 5 4  
 ♥ Q 6  
 ♦ J T 4  
 ♣ A 7 2



♠ K T 7 6  
 ♥ 8 3 2  
 ♦ K 6 5  
 ♣ J 8 4

♠ A  
 ♥ A K J T 7 4  
 ♦ A 9 3  
 ♣ 6 5 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1 ♥   |
| Pass     | 1 ♠   | Pass | 3 ♥   |
| Pass     | 4 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4 ♥ by South

You might consider setting up dummy's ♠ suit for a discard but there are too few entries to make that work.

More promising is playing East to have at least one of the ♦ honors and taking two finesses in that suit. **BUT**, entries are still a problem. You can only reach dummy twice, once with the ♣A and once with the ♥Q, and you must play ♦s each time you are there.

Win the first trick with the ♣A and play the ♦J, letting it ride if East doesn't cover. West will win this trick and take two ♣s. He will probably then lead a ♠. You win your ♠A, play ♥A then a small ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. Now lead a ♦ and finesse with your ♦9. When this wins, pull trumps and claim.

Taking two finesses in ♦s will be successful whenever East holds the ♦K **OR** the ♦Q **OR** both the ♦K Q.

This will happen about 75% of the time, so the double finesse is a good Plan. And on this Deal it was the only plan available.

You respond 1 ♠, your 5-card Major. Partner jumps to 3 ♥.

Make your next bid.

Partner is showing 16-18 points and you have 9. Since he rebid ♥s he must have at least six of them you you know there is an 8-card fit. You bid 4 ♥.

North would play 4 ♥.

Click

South plays 4 ♥. West leads the ♣K.

**South plays 4 ♥. West leads the ♣K.**

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7  
 ♥ A K Q 8 6 2  
 ♦ A 5  
 ♣ Q 9 5 3

♠ 9 8 4

♥ J 5

♦ T 9 8

♣ A K T 7 4



♠ A J 6 5 2

♥ T 4

♦ Q 7 4 3

♣ J 6

♠ K Q T 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 2

You respond with your 5-card Major, 1♠.

Partner jumps to 3♥.

With partner's 16-18 points you probably have enough strength for game.

With partner's six ♥s you have an 8-card fit.

So you bid 4♥.

East would play 4♥.

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| 1♥       | Pass  | 1♠   | Pass  |
| 3♥       | Pass  | 4♥   |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by West

**West plays 4♥. North leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. South plays ♣8 then ♣2.**

Click

West plays 4♥. North leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. South plays ♣8 then ♣2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Suppose you discard a ♦ from dummy. If South doesn't ruff this ♣ Then your ♣Q will win. You could then try to establish dummy's ♦Q to discard your fourth ♣ on.

But you know that plan won't work because South **IS** going to ruff this ♣ if you discard. You only have one chance to make this contract, and that is the chance that South was not dealt the ♥J. So you ruff with dummy's ♥10 and pray South doesn't over-ruff.

The prayer was answered, South did not hold the ♥J.

So you won that trick and still had your ♣Q to use after you pulled trumps.